Bolshevik Revolution. This time it was a special occasion—the forty-fifth anniversary of the coup d'état, called the October Revolution, in Petrograd, then the capital of the Russian Empire. Soviet embassies all over the world hosted special receptions, and Havana was no exception. Upset by the Soviets, Fidel Castro ignored Ambassador Alekseev's invitation to a festive dinner at the Soviet embassy, but other high-ranking Cuban officials, led by Raúl Castro, showed up.

The Soviets were prepared to forgive the absence of the chief Cuban communist and Marxist but were upset by the behavior of Cuban officials at the event. The chief of Cuban military intelligence, Pedro Luis Rodríguez, proposed a toast to Fidel Castro and Joseph Stalin. General Gribkov and other Soviet commanders at the table, who had drunk to the previous toast in honor of Khrushchev and Castro, refused to raise their glasses. "His words came down to the notion that if Stalin had been alive, then the missiles would have remained in Cuba," recalled General Anatoly Gribkov, the representative of the General Staff in Cuba, who was sitting at the same table as Rodríguez. Later that night he mentioned the Rodríguez episode in his report on the day's developments to Marshal Malinovsky. Malinovsky passed it to Khrushchev, who became furious and ordered an investigation. As far as he was concerned, the Cubans were in revolt.[14]

By the fall of 1962, Stalin had become anathema in the Soviet Union. In the official report on the anniversary of the October Revolution delivered that year in Moscow by the future prime minister of the Soviet Union, Aleksei Kosygin, Stalin's name was not mentioned, and the report lauded Soviet economic achievements since 1953, the year of Stalin's death. The party congress held the previous autumn decided to remove Stalin's body from the mausoleum: the dictator was buried instead near the Kremlin wall. As far as the Soviet leaders were concerned, he did not exist. But it turned out that Stalin was very much on the mind of Khrushchev's Cuban allies, who were disappointed with his retreat in the face of world imperialism.[15]

Khrushchev's investigation of the Rodríguez episode was one more piece of bad news for Mikoyan. Not that he was an admirer of Stalin, but he knew nothing about Gribkov's report to Moscow and wrote nothing about Rodríguez to Moscow himself. Now it looked as if he were either unaware of what was going on under his nose at the Soviet embassy or, worse, as if